

FREE PLAYBOOK · 2026 EDITION

58 SEO quick wins for founders

Fixes you can ship this month to get found on Google and recommended in AI answers. Each one comes with the steps and a copy-paste AI prompt.

20

FOUNDATIONS

16

AI SEARCH

10

LOCAL AND
REPUTATION

12

ADVANCED



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How to use this playbook

Each win is a small, specific job. None of them needs an agency. Most need an hour, a login to your website and Google Search Console, and a little patience while search engines catch up.

Every win has 3 parts

- **Why it matters** tells you what the fix changes.
- **How to do it** gives the steps in order.
- **AI prompt** is ready to paste into ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini. Swap the [BRACKETS] for your details.

The labels

- **Time** is a rough estimate for a site of 20 to 100 pages.
- **You** means anyone with website access can do it. **Web dev** means you'll want help from whoever built the site.
- **New for 2026** marks wins built for how search and AI answers work now.

Before you paste a prompt

- Give the AI your real data: Search Console exports, page text, customer emails. It does far better work on your data than on guesses.
- Check every fact, number and claim before it goes on your site. AI tools invent details with total confidence.
- Add your own experience to anything AI drafts. First-hand detail is what readers and search engines reward.
- Stuck? End any prompt with: "Ask me questions until you have enough information to do this well."

Where to start

- Set up Search Console and GA4 first, so you can see what each fix changes.
- Then work through Part 1. The other parts build on it.
- Local business? Do Part 3 early. It moves fastest for you.

What's inside

01	Foundations	20 wins
02	Get found in AI search	16 wins
03	Local and reputation wins	10 wins
04	Advanced wins	12 wins
05	Your 58-win checklist	Tracker

What changed from older SEO checklists

Google has retired several features that older lists still recommend. FAQ rich results now show only for government and health sites. HowTo rich results and the sitelinks search box are gone. Those items are out.

In their place are wins for AI search. ChatGPT, Perplexity, Copilot and Google's AI Overviews now answer many of the questions your customers ask, and they pull from different places. In one study cited in Carter's *The New Rules of AI Search* (2026), only 10 to 12% of the pages ChatGPT cited also ranked in Google's top 10. Google rankings still feed many AI answers, so Part 1 comes first. Parts 2 and 3 cover the rest.

Foundations

The basics that help search engines find and rank your pages, plus the simple fixes that turn visits into leads. Every AI search tool builds on these too.

01 Set up Google Analytics 4 and Search Console properly



2 HOURS

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Without these two you can't tell which fixes worked. Search Console shows how Google sees your site. GA4 shows what visitors do once they arrive, including whether they become leads.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Verify your site in Search Console as a Domain property, which covers every version of your address.
2. Confirm GA4 is collecting data by visiting your site and watching the Realtime report.
3. Link Search Console to GA4 under Admin, then Product links.
4. Mark form submissions, calls and bookings as key events so you can count leads.

AI PROMPT

I'm a small business owner setting up Google Analytics 4 and Google Search Console for [WEBSITE] on [CMS]. My main conversion is [e.g. booking a call]. Give me a step-by-step checklist to verify both, link them, and track that conversion as a key event. Assume I'm not technical.

02 Rewrite titles and meta descriptions on your top 10 pages ☐

2 HOURS

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Your title is the first thing a searcher reads, and it decides whether they click. A page can sit on page 1 and still lose clicks to a clearer headline above or below it.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In Search Console, open Performance, then the Pages tab, and sort by impressions.
2. For each of the top 10 pages, check which queries it shows up for and put the main one near the front of the title.
3. Keep titles under about 60 characters and descriptions under about 155 so they don't get cut off.
4. Write the description as a reason to click: who the page is for and what they'll get.

AI PROMPT

Here is a page URL, its current title tag and meta description, and the top 5 search queries it gets impressions for in Google Search Console: [PASTE]. Write 3 title tags under 60 characters that lead with the main query, and 3 meta descriptions under 155 characters that tell the searcher what they will get. Use plain language, no hype words, no clickbait.

03 Fix your heading structure ☐

1 HOUR

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Headings are how search engines and skimming readers work out what a page covers. AI systems split pages into chunks by heading, so a clear heading makes each section easy to find and quote.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Check a page's headings with a free browser extension like HeadingsMap.
2. Give each page one H1 that says what the page is about.
3. Rename vague H2s like "Overview" or "Our approach" so each one says what the section answers.
4. Keep the levels in order (H2, then H3) and don't use headings for styling.

AI PROMPT

Here are the headings on my page, in order, with their levels: [PASTE]. The page is about [TOPIC] for [AUDIENCE]. Rewrite them so there is one H1, each H2 describes the specific question or topic its section answers, and no levels are skipped. Keep my wording where it already works.

04 Link from your strongest pages to your weakest



1 HOUR YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Internal links tell search engines which pages matter and pass authority between them. A page with few links pointing to it is harder to find and easier to ignore.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In Search Console, open Links, then Internal links, to see which pages get the most links.
2. Pick 3 to 5 pages that rank on page 2 or have hardly any internal links.
3. From your strongest related pages, add a link to each, using words that describe the target page.
4. Use normal text links. Links that only work through JavaScript or buttons are harder for crawlers to follow.

AI PROMPT

Here is a list of my site's pages with their titles and URLs: [PASTE]. My target page is [URL], about [TOPIC]. Pick the 5 pages most relevant for linking to it. For each, write one natural sentence I could add that includes a descriptive link to the target page.

05 Compress and resize your images



2 HOURS YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Oversized images are the most common reason small business sites load slowly. A 3 MB photo can usually shrink to under 500 KB with no visible difference, and a faster page keeps visitors and crawlers from giving up.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Run your 5 busiest pages through PageSpeed Insights and note the image warnings.
2. Resize each image to the largest size it displays at, usually no wider than 1600 pixels.
3. Convert to WebP with a free tool like Squoosh, or turn on compression in your CMS.
4. Turn on lazy loading for images further down the page.

AI PROMPT

I run a [CMS, e.g. WordPress, Squarespace, Webflow] site. Here is the image section of my PageSpeed Insights report: [PASTE]. Explain in plain English which images are causing problems, and give me step-by-step instructions to fix each one in my CMS without a developer.

06 Write alt text that describes the image



1 HOUR YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Alt text describes an image to screen readers and search engines, which can't see the picture. It helps you show up in image search, and it's one more place to say where you work.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Crawl your site with Screaming Frog (free up to 500 URLs) and export images with missing alt text.
2. Describe each image in one short sentence, the way you would to someone on the phone.
3. Add your service or location when it's true, for example "Team installing a new roof in Green Hills, Nashville".
4. Leave alt text empty on decorative images like dividers and background shapes.

AI PROMPT

I'll upload images from my [TYPE OF BUSINESS] website in [CITY]. For each, write alt text under 125 characters that describes what's in the image for someone who can't see it. Mention the service or location only when it's accurate to the image. Flag any image that looks decorative and should have empty alt text.

07 Make every page load over HTTPS



1 HOUR YOU + WEB DEV

WHY IT MATTERS

Browsers label non-HTTPS pages "Not secure", which costs you trust before anyone reads a word. HTTPS is also a confirmed Google ranking signal, if a light one.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Type your domain with http:// in front and check it redirects to https://.
2. Open a few pages and look for a padlock warning, which usually means an image or script still loads over http.
3. Find those files with a free checker like Why No Padlock and update their links.
4. Set one site-wide permanent redirect so every http address goes to its https version.

AI PROMPT

My website is on [HOST or CMS]. Some pages show a "Not secure" or mixed-content warning. Here is the list of insecure resources a checker found: [PASTE]. Explain what each one is and give me the exact steps to fix it on my platform, plus how to set up a permanent site-wide redirect from http to https.

08 Fix broken internal links



1 HOUR YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Every broken link is a dead end for a visitor and wasted effort for a crawler. They pile up quietly every time a page is renamed or deleted.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Crawl the site with Screaming Frog and filter for 4xx response codes.
2. Update each broken link to the correct live page.
3. If the page is gone for good, link to the closest replacement or remove the link.
4. Crawl again to confirm the list is empty.

AI PROMPT

Here is a list of broken internal links from a site crawl, showing the page each link is on and the dead URL it points to: [PASTE]. Here is a list of my live URLs: [PASTE]. For each broken link, suggest the best live replacement page, or say "remove" if nothing fits.

09 Submit a clean XML sitemap



30 MINUTES YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

A sitemap hands search engines a list of the pages you want found. It speeds up discovery of new and updated pages, which matters most for small sites with few links from elsewhere.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Find your sitemap, usually at yourdomain.com/sitemap.xml. Most CMSs create one automatically.
2. Check it lists only live pages you want found: no redirects, errors or noindex pages.
3. Add a line to your robots.txt file that says Sitemap: followed by the sitemap's full address. Many sites miss this.
4. Submit it in Search Console under Sitemaps and check back after a week for errors.

AI PROMPT

Here is my XML sitemap and a list of URLs from a site crawl with their status codes and indexability: [PASTE BOTH]. List every URL in the sitemap that shouldn't be there (redirects, errors, noindex pages, duplicates) and every live, indexable page that's missing from it.

10

Add canonical tags to stop duplicate pages competing



1 HOUR

YOU + WEB DEV

WHY IT MATTERS

The same page often lives at several addresses: with and without a trailing slash, with filters, or as a print version. A canonical tag tells Google which one to rank, so the copies don't split your signals.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In Search Console, open Pages and look for "Duplicate without user-selected canonical".
2. Check every page has a canonical tag pointing to itself. Most SEO plugins add this.
3. For true duplicates, point the canonical to the version you want ranked.
4. Spot-check a few pages with the URL Inspection tool.

AI PROMPT

Here are URLs from my site that Google Search Console flags as duplicates: [PASTE]. Group the ones that look like the same content, recommend the canonical URL for each group, and explain in plain English whether each needs a canonical tag or a 301 redirect.

1 HOUR

YOU + WEB DEV

WHY IT MATTERS

Schema is code that states facts about your business in a format search engines read without guessing: name, address, hours, services. It helps Google and Bing connect your site to your business listings.

AI chat tools mostly don't read schema directly. They benefit through the search engines that do, so treat this as a search fix.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick the most specific type on schema.org that fits you, such as Plumber, Dentist or ProfessionalService.
2. Fill in name, website, logo, address, phone, hours and service area.
3. Add it to your homepage as JSON-LD through your SEO plugin or the site header, in the page code itself.
4. Test it at validator.schema.org. Google's Rich Results Test won't show this type, so a blank result there is normal.

AI PROMPT

Write JSON-LD schema for my business using the most specific schema.org type for a [TYPE OF BUSINESS]. Details: name [], URL [], logo URL [], address [], phone [], hours [], service area [], social profiles []. Output only valid JSON-LD I can paste into my site header, and list any recommended fields I left blank.

12

Answer real customer questions on your service pages



2 HOURS

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

The questions prospects ask on sales calls are the same ones they type into Google and ChatGPT. Answering them on the page helps you rank for those searches and gives AI tools a clear answer to quote.

Google has shown FAQ rich results only for government and health sites since 2023, so the value is in the answers themselves.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Collect 5 questions from sales calls, emails, reviews and the "People also ask" box for your main service.
2. Use each question as a heading and answer it in 2 to 3 sentences, with the direct answer first.
3. Follow with a real example and a next step if there's room.
4. Spread them across the pages they belong to: service, pricing and location pages.

AI PROMPT

Here are notes from sales calls and customer emails for my [SERVICE] business: [PASTE]. Pull out the 8 questions prospects ask most often. For each, draft a 2 to 3 sentence answer that leads with the direct answer, using only facts from my notes. Mark anything you had to guess with [CHECK].

13

Delay scripts that slow your pages down



2 HOURS

YOU + WEB DEV

WHY IT MATTERS

Chat widgets, tracking pixels and embedded feeds often load before your content and make the page slow to respond. Delaying them lets the page appear and react to taps first.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In PageSpeed Insights, look at "Reduce unused JavaScript" and "Reduce the impact of third-party code".
2. List every third-party script and ask whether you still use it. Remove the dead ones.
3. Set the rest to load after the page, using your CMS, a plugin or Google Tag Manager.
4. Re-run PageSpeed Insights to compare.

AI PROMPT

Here is the list of third-party scripts from my PageSpeed Insights report: [PASTE]. For each one, tell me what it probably is, whether it's safe to delay until after the page loads, and how to delay it on [CMS]. Flag any that look unused or duplicated.

14 Shorten messy URLs



1 HOUR

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Short, readable web addresses are easier to trust and share. They also tell search engines and readers what the page covers before it opens.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Use short, lowercase addresses with hyphens and no dates or ID numbers for every new page.
2. Change existing addresses only when they're clearly bad, since every change needs a redirect.
3. When you change one, add a 301 redirect from the old address and update your internal links.
4. Resubmit your sitemap afterwards.

AI PROMPT

Here are URLs from my site with their page titles: [PASTE]. Suggest a shorter, readable slug for any that are long or contain dates, IDs or filler words. For each change, write the 301 redirect as FROM -> TO. Leave URLs that are already fine alone.

15 Show a "last updated" date



1 HOUR

YOU + WEB DEV

WHY IT MATTERS

Readers want to know advice is current, and so do search engines and AI tools choosing which source to cite. When two sources say similar things, AI systems tend to prefer the newer one.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Show a "Last updated" date near the top of blog posts, guides, pricing and comparison pages.
2. Change it only when you make a real content update. Typo fixes don't count.
3. Make sure your article schema carries the same date as dateModified.
4. Check your CMS doesn't bump the date on every small template change. A fake-fresh date does more harm than no date.

AI PROMPT

I use [CMS]. Explain how to show a "Last updated" date at the top of blog posts that pulls from each post's modified date, how to make sure my article schema includes a matching dateModified, and how to stop the date changing when nothing on the page changed. Give steps for a non-developer first.

16 Refresh one post that's losing traffic



HALF DAY

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Updating a post that already ranks is usually faster than publishing a new one. Posts slide as their stats age and competitors cover subtopics they skipped.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In Search Console, compare the last 3 months with the 3 before and find a post whose clicks have dropped.
2. Look at the pages now ranking above it and note what they cover that yours doesn't.
3. Update facts, examples and links, add the missing sections, and add a first-hand example from your own work.
4. Update the date, write "as of [month year]" next to time-sensitive facts, and request indexing in Search Console.

AI PROMPT

Here is my blog post [PASTE] and the headings of the 3 pages that now outrank it [PASTE]. List what my post is missing or has out of date, in order of importance, and suggest where a first-hand example from my own work would fit. Give me an edit list only.

17 Fix your favicon



15 MINUTES

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Your favicon is the small icon in the browser tab, and it's often the only image shown next to your link in Google, Perplexity and Gemini. When it's missing, you get a grey globe that looks abandoned.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Search your brand name on Google and on Perplexity and look at the icon next to your result.
2. Make a square version of your logo that still reads at small sizes. Initials often work better than the full logo.
3. Upload it as the site icon in your CMS settings, at least 48 by 48 pixels.
4. Check it again in a week or two.

AI PROMPT

I need a favicon for [BUSINESS]. My logo is [DESCRIBE or UPLOAD]. Suggest 3 simple square designs that will still be readable at 16 by 16 pixels, and tell me which file sizes and formats to export and where to upload them in [CMS].

18

Add a call to action to your top blog posts



1 HOUR

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Blog posts often bring in the most traffic and the fewest leads, because nobody tells the reader what to do next. One relevant offer at the right moment turns some of those readers into enquiries.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In GA4, find your 5 most visited blog posts.
2. Pick the one next step that fits each post: a call, a checklist or a related service page.
3. Add it once near the top for skimmers and once at the end.
4. Track clicks on it as a key event in GA4.

AI PROMPT

Here is the text of one of my most visited blog posts: [PASTE]. My services are [LIST] and my free resource is [NAME]. Suggest the single most relevant next step for someone who read this post, and write 2 short calls to action under 40 words each, one for mid-post and one for the end. No pressure tactics.

19

Add a sticky call or book button on mobile



1 HOUR

YOU + WEB DEV

WHY IT MATTERS

Many visitors arrive on a phone, and they won't scroll back up to find your number. A button that stays on screen makes the next step one tap.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Add a fixed bar at the bottom of mobile screens on your service and contact pages.
2. Offer one action: call, book or get a quote.
3. Make it big enough to tap with a thumb, and don't let it cover content.
4. Track taps as a key event in GA4.

AI PROMPT

Write the HTML and CSS for a sticky bottom bar that only shows on screens under 768px wide, with one button labelled [LABEL] linking to [tel: number or booking URL]. Make it accessible and at least 48px tall, and add bottom padding to the page so it doesn't cover content. Include instructions for adding it on [CMS].

20 Offer a free resource on your top information post



HALF DAY

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Most people reading an information post aren't ready to buy yet. A useful download gets their email now, so you can follow up when they are.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick the information post with the most traffic.
2. Create one short resource that takes the post further: a checklist, template or calculator.
3. Offer it in a box mid-post and at the end.
4. Send a short welcome email sequence to people who download it.

AI PROMPT

Here is my most-visited information post: [PASTE]. Suggest 3 free resource ideas a reader would want right after reading it, each something I could make in under a day. For the best one, write the title, a 2-sentence description for the signup box, and the button text.

Get found in AI search

Customers now ask ChatGPT, Perplexity, Copilot and Google's AI Overviews. These wins make your business easy for all of them to find, read, quote and track.

21 Publish a brand facts page

2 HOURS

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

When ChatGPT or Perplexity answers a question about your business, it pulls from whatever it can find. One page of clear, current facts gives it an accurate source, and gives you one place to update when something changes.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Create a page like /facts with a table: Claim, Value, Source, Last verified.
2. Cover what you do, who you serve, where, since when, founders, pricing approach and what you don't offer.
3. Link it from your About page and footer, and update it whenever a fact changes.
4. Optional, 10 minutes: add a short llms.txt file that points to this page and your main pages. No AI company has confirmed using it, but it costs nothing.

AI PROMPT

Interview me to build a brand facts page. Ask me one question at a time about my business: what we do, who we serve, locations, founding date, team, services, pricing approach, and what we don't offer. When done, write the page as a table with columns Claim, Value, Source and Last verified, using only my answers.

22 Connect your people and brand with schema



1 HOUR

YOU + WEB DEV

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Search engines try to work out who is behind a site and whether they're credible. Schema that links your authors and brand to their LinkedIn and other profiles connects the dots. The most important field is sameAs, the list of your official profiles.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Add Organization schema to the homepage with sameAs links to LinkedIn, Google Business Profile and other official profiles.
2. Give each writer an author page with Person schema: name, job title, photo and sameAs links.
3. Connect blog posts to their author with the author field.
4. Check it at validator.schema.org.

AI PROMPT

Write JSON-LD for (1) an Organization with name [], URL [], logo [] and sameAs links [], and (2) a Person for [NAME], [JOB TITLE] at that organization, with image [] and sameAs links []. Connect them with worksFor. Output valid JSON-LD only.

23 Set up Bing Webmaster Tools and IndexNow



30 MINUTES

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Bing's index feeds Microsoft Copilot and much of ChatGPT's search, so being missing from Bing means being missing from those answers. Many small sites never verify it, and their new pages get picked up late.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Sign up at Bing Webmaster Tools and import your site straight from Google Search Console.
2. Submit your sitemap.
3. Turn on IndexNow, built into many CMSs and SEO plugins, so new and updated pages get flagged to Bing right away.
4. Check the search performance report for the queries, including AI-generated ones, that bring up your pages.

AI PROMPT

I've verified my site in Bing Webmaster Tools. Here is the list of issues from its Site Scan report: [PASTE]. Group them by severity, explain each in plain English, and tell me which ones I can fix myself on [CMS] and which need a developer.

24 Put the answer first in every section

2 HOURS

YOU

NEW FOR 2026



WHY IT MATTERS

AI tools split pages into chunks and quote the ones that answer the question on their own. They give the most weight to the first sentence or two of each section. Many pages bury the answer after 3 paragraphs of setup.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In Search Console, find pages ranking in positions 2 to 20 for question-style searches.
2. Under the heading that matches the question, add a 2 to 3 sentence answer that makes sense if quoted alone.
3. Put the detail, examples and lists after it.
4. Put a one-line summary at the top of your homepage too: what you do, for whom, where.

AI PROMPT

Here is a section of my article under the heading [HEADING]: [PASTE]. Write a 2 to 3 sentence answer to the heading's question that would make sense if quoted alone, using only facts from the section. Then suggest whether a short list or table would help below it.

25 Build a glossary of your industry's terms

HALF DAY

YOU



WHY IT MATTERS

"What is a..." searches are common in every industry, and AI tools answer them constantly. Short, clear definition pages win those searches and show you know the field.

HOW TO DO IT

1. List 15 to 25 terms your customers ask about or get confused by.
2. Define each in 1 to 2 sentences first, then add an example and a link to the related service.
3. Group them on one glossary page that links to each term.
4. Link to the terms from blog posts where they come up.

AI PROMPT

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] serving [AUDIENCE]. List 25 terms my customers are likely to search for or misunderstand. For 3 of them, draft a glossary entry: a 1 to 2 sentence definition first, then a short example relevant to [AUDIENCE]. I'll fact-check before publishing.

26 Publish a page of sourced statistics



HALF DAY

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Writers and AI tools look for numbers to cite, and they link to the source. The Princeton GEO study found that adding statistics and cited sources raised a page's visibility in AI answers by up to 40%.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Collect 10 to 20 statistics your customers care about, each from a named source with a year.
2. Write each as one sentence with the number first and the source named in the same sentence.
3. Add your own data if you have any: "We inspected 100 roofs in Nashville this year". Nobody else can copy it.
4. Review the page every 6 months.

AI PROMPT

I'm building a statistics page about [TOPIC] for [AUDIENCE]. Here are the sources and figures I've collected: [PASTE]. Write each as one clear sentence with the number first and the source and year named in the sentence. Group them under 3 to 5 headings. Don't add any statistics I didn't give you.

27 Add comparison tables



1 HOUR

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

People comparing options want a side-by-side view, and AI tools lift tables straight into their answers because they're already organized. A plain HTML table does the job.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick a page where readers weigh options: your service tiers, hiring you versus doing it in-house, or tool A versus tool B.
2. Build the table in real HTML text, never as an image.
3. Keep the rows to what buyers ask about: price range, time, who it suits.
4. Add a sentence under it saying who should pick which option.

AI PROMPT

Build a comparison table for [OPTION A] vs [OPTION B] vs [OPTION C] for [AUDIENCE]. Rows: [FACTORS, e.g. cost, time to results, skills needed, best for]. Use only these facts: [PASTE]. Output as an HTML table, then one sentence per option saying who it suits.

28 Publish one "best for" or "alternatives" page



HALF DAY

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Buyers close to a decision ask AI tools things like "best [service] for [situation]" or "alternatives to [competitor]". A fair, specific page on that question puts you in the answer at the moment they're choosing.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick the comparison your prospects bring up most on sales calls.
2. Write a fair page with a short comparison table and a clear "best for" line for each option, including when you're not the right fit.
3. Link it from your homepage and related service pages.
4. Keep prices and features current and show the last updated date.

AI PROMPT

Help me write a fair comparison page titled [e.g. "Alternatives to COMPETITOR for SMALL BUSINESSES"]. Here are the options and facts about each: [PASTE]. Write an intro, a comparison table, and a 2 to 3 sentence "best for" section per option, including when my business is not the best fit. No attacks on competitors.

29 Add breadcrumbs



1 HOUR

YOU + WEB DEV

WHY IT MATTERS

Breadcrumbs show visitors where they are on your site and give search engines a clear map of how pages relate. They also add a link on every page back up to its category.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Turn on breadcrumbs in your theme or SEO plugin.
2. Make the trail follow your real structure, like Home > Services > Bookkeeping.
3. Confirm BreadcrumbList schema is included and check it at validator.schema.org.
4. Check how it looks on mobile.

AI PROMPT

Here is my site's page list with URLs: [PASTE]. Propose a clean category structure for breadcrumbs, no more than 3 levels deep, and show the breadcrumb trail for 5 example pages. Then write the BreadcrumbList JSON-LD for one of them.

30 Add a table of contents with jump links



30 MINUTES

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Long guides are easier to use with a clickable table of contents. Google sometimes shows those jump links in search results, and AI tools use the anchors to point readers to the exact section.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Add a table of contents to any post over about 1,500 words.
2. Link each entry to the matching H2 with an anchor.
3. Keep the anchor names short and readable.
4. Most CMSs and SEO plugins have a block for this.

AI PROMPT

Here are the H2 headings of my article: [PASTE]. Write a short table of contents with a readable anchor ID for each heading (lowercase, hyphens), and give me the HTML for the list plus the matching id attribute to add to each heading.

31 Add chapters and captions to your videos



1 HOUR PER VIDEO

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

YouTube is one of the most cited sources in AI answers, partly because chapters and transcripts split videos into neat pieces. Chapters also let Google send people to the exact minute that answers their question.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Add labelled timestamps to each YouTube description, starting at 0:00.
2. Name each chapter the way someone would search for that moment.
3. Upload or correct the captions so the transcript is accurate.
4. Say your main topic out loud early in the video, since the transcript is what AI tools read.

AI PROMPT

Here is the transcript of my video with timestamps: [PASTE]. Split it into 5 to 10 chapters. Give each a start time and a label under 8 words phrased the way someone would search for it. Format them for a YouTube description starting at 0:00.

32 Track visits from AI assistants in GA4



30 MINUTES

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

GA4 lumps visits from ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Copilot into general referral traffic by default. Separating them shows whether AI tools send you anyone, and which pages they send them to.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In GA4, go to Admin, Data display, Channel groups and create a new channel group.
2. Add a channel called AI assistants with Session source matching this regex:
`chatgpt|openai|perplexity|claude|gemini|copilot`
3. Move it above Referral in the list and save.
4. Check it monthly. It only catches visits that pass a referrer, so treat it as a minimum.

AI PROMPT

Walk me through creating a custom channel group in Google Analytics 4 that separates traffic from AI assistants (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, Copilot, Claude) from other referral traffic. Include the regex, where it goes in the channel order, and how to build a report showing which landing pages get this traffic.

33 Add "AI assistant" to your "How did you hear about us?" field



15 MINUTES

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Many people who find you through ChatGPT or Perplexity arrive later by typing your name, so analytics records them as direct visits. Asking them is the only reliable way to count them.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Open your contact, quote and booking forms.
2. Add "AI assistant (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, Copilot)" as an option in the source question.
3. Make the question required.
4. Review the answers monthly next to your GA4 numbers.

AI PROMPT

Here are the current options in my "How did you hear about us?" form field: [PASTE]. Rewrite the list so it's short, clear and includes AI assistants as a source, then suggest one optional follow-up question that tells me what they searched or asked.

34 Ask AI tools who they recommend, every month



1 HOUR A MONTH

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Asking the AI tools your customers use shows whether you're named, who's named instead, and which websites the answers come from.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Write 10 to 20 questions a buyer would ask, like "Who's the best [service] in [city]?" or "[service] for [type of business]".
2. Ask each one in ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity and Copilot.
3. Log in a spreadsheet who gets named and which sources are cited.
4. AI answers change from one ask to the next, so look for trends across months and work on the sources that keep coming up.

AI PROMPT

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] in [CITY] serving [AUDIENCE]. Write 15 questions a potential customer might ask an AI assistant when looking for a business like mine, mixing "best", "cost", "how to choose" and comparison questions. Then give me a spreadsheet layout to log the results each month.

35 Make sure AI crawlers aren't blocked by your firewall



30 MINUTES

YOU + WEB DEV

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Bot protection from services like Cloudflare can quietly block the crawlers that ChatGPT, Claude and Perplexity use to read your site. You'd never know, except that you never show up.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Ask whoever manages your hosting or Cloudflare account whether AI bots are blocked or challenged.
2. Allow the search crawlers: OAI-SearchBot and ChatGPT-User (OpenAI), Claude-SearchBot and Claude-User (Anthropic), PerplexityBot, and Bingbot.
3. Check CAPTCHAs and login walls aren't sitting in front of public pages.
4. Recheck after any hosting or security change.

AI PROMPT

My site uses [HOST, e.g. Cloudflare, WP Engine, Squarespace]. Explain how to check whether its bot protection blocks AI search crawlers like OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User, Claude-SearchBot and PerplexityBot, and give me step-by-step instructions to allow them while keeping protection against spam bots.

36

Get important facts out of images and PDFs



1 HOUR

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Text inside an image, a PDF price list or a chart doesn't exist for most crawlers. If your prices, service areas or credentials only live there, AI tools can't see them.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Go through your main pages and note any facts that only appear inside images, PDFs, sliders or tabs.
2. Add the same information as plain text on the page.
3. Keep the image if it helps, with alt text that summarizes it.
4. Give each PDF you keep a matching web page.

AI PROMPT

I'll upload an image or PDF from my website: [UPLOAD]. Pull out every fact in it (prices, services, areas, credentials, dates) and rewrite them as short, clear web copy with headings, so I can add them to the page as text.

Local and reputation wins

When someone asks "who's the best near me", Google and AI tools lean on your profile, listings, reviews and local mentions. These wins build all four.

37 Refresh your Google Business Profile

2 HOURS

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

For local searches, the map results often get more attention than the regular results. Google's AI tools also lean on your profile, reviews and Maps data when they recommend a business.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Set your primary category to the most specific one that fits, and add secondary categories for other services.
2. Fill in every field: services, hours, holiday hours, service area and business description.
3. Upload at least 10 real photos of your team, your work and your location.
4. Post an update, offer or recent project at least twice a month.

AI PROMPT

Here is my current Google Business Profile: categories, description and services [PASTE]. My business does [WHAT YOU DO] for [WHO] in [AREA]. Suggest the best primary and secondary categories, rewrite the description in under 750 characters without keyword stuffing, and draft 4 short update posts I can publish this month.

38 Clean up your business listings across the web



HALF DAY

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Search engines and AI tools cross-check your business name, address and phone number across the web. Mismatches, down to "St." versus "Street", weaken local rankings and send customers to the wrong place.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Search your business name in quotes and check the top 10 results for wrong details.
2. Fix the 3 worst listings today.
3. Then cover the rest: Apple Business Connect, Bing Places, Yelp, BBB, Facebook and 3 to 5 industry directories.
4. Keep them in a spreadsheet so the next move or number change takes an hour.

AI PROMPT

My business is a [TYPE] in [CITY, STATE]. List the 10 business directories and platforms that matter most for local search for this type of business in the US, including industry-specific ones. For each, give the URL where a business claims or edits its listing. Format it as a table I can paste into a spreadsheet.

39 Ask for reviews the right way



1 HOUR TO SET UP

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Review count, recency and rating all feed local rankings and AI recommendations, and they're the first thing people read before calling. Recent reviews count most.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Get your direct review link from your Google Business Profile.
2. Ask right after a clear win, by text or email, with the link.
3. Ask customers to mention the service, the problem you solved and their neighborhood.
4. Send most requests to one platform, usually Google. Never offer incentives, which breaks Google's rules.

AI PROMPT

Write a short text message and a short email asking a happy customer to leave a Google review for [BUSINESS] after we [SERVICE]. Include [LINK]. Ask them to mention what we did and what stood out, in their own words. Friendly, under 60 words each, no incentives.

40 Reply to every review within 48 hours

15 MINUTES A WEEK

YOU



WHY IT MATTERS

Replies show future customers you care, and AI tools read them alongside the reviews. A good reply also adds useful detail about your services and area.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Start with your last 3 unanswered reviews today.
2. Thank the reviewer for their specific situation and name the service you provided.
3. Mention their area naturally, and sign with your name and role.
4. For bad reviews, acknowledge the issue without arguing and offer a direct contact.

AI PROMPT

Here are my recent Google reviews: [PASTE]. Draft a reply to each under 70 words. Thank the reviewer for their specific situation, name the service, mention their area if they did, and sign as [NAME, ROLE]. For negative reviews, acknowledge the issue without arguing and invite them to contact [PHONE or EMAIL]. Vary the wording.

41 Put named testimonials on your service pages

1 HOUR

YOU



WHY IT MATTERS

Prospects decide on the service page, so that's where proof belongs. A named testimonial with a specific result answers the question they're asking at that moment. Google doesn't show review stars for reviews a business publishes about itself, so skip the markup.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick 2 or 3 testimonials per service that mention a specific result.
2. Add full name, company and a photo where the client agrees.
3. Place one near the top and one next to the call to action.
4. Get permission in writing and keep the originals.

AI PROMPT

Here are raw testimonials and client emails: [PASTE]. For each of my services [LIST], pick the 2 strongest quotes that mention a specific result. Trim each to under 50 words without changing the meaning, and list what I should ask the client to confirm before publishing.

42 Show up on your industry's trusted review site

2 HOURS

YOU

NEW FOR 2026



WHY IT MATTERS

AI tools lean on certain review sites for certain industries: Clutch for agencies, Avvo for lawyers, Angi for trades, G2 and Capterra for software. A strong profile there can matter more than a pile of reviews somewhere nobody checks.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Ask ChatGPT and Perplexity "best [your service] in [city]" and note which review sites they cite.
2. Claim your profile on the one that comes up most.
3. Fill it in completely, matching your Google Business Profile details.
4. Point a few happy clients there for reviews.

AI PROMPT

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] in [CITY]. Which review and directory sites are most trusted in my industry in the US, and which are most likely to be cited by AI assistants? For the top 3, tell me how to claim a profile and what a complete profile includes.

43 Build one page per core city you serve

HALF DAY PER PAGE

YOU

NEW FOR 2026



WHY IT MATTERS

"[Service] in [city]" is how most local buyers search and ask AI tools. A genuine page for each main city gives both something specific to match.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Create a page for each city that brings you real work, with the city in the H1.
2. Include neighborhoods served, local testimonials, project photos and local details like climate or building codes.
3. Add a short local FAQ and embed a Google Map.
4. Skip thin pages for every suburb. List smaller areas or ZIP codes on one service area page instead.

AI PROMPT

Help me write a city page for [SERVICE] in [CITY]. Here's what I know about working there: neighborhoods [], typical jobs [], local conditions [], testimonials []. Write an H1, intro, sections and a 4-question local FAQ using only these details. Mark anywhere I should add a photo or a specific example.

44 Turn unlinked mentions into links



1 HOUR

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Anyone who already mentioned your business by name is the easiest link you'll ever get. They know you, and adding a link takes them a minute.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Search Google for your business name in quotes, adding -site:yourdomain.com to hide your own pages.
2. Do the same for your own name, and set Google Alerts for both.
3. List mentions that don't link to you.
4. Send a short thank-you note asking if they'd link the mention to your site.

AI PROMPT

Write a short, friendly email to [NAME] at [SITE], who mentioned my business [BUSINESS] in their article [TITLE or URL] without a link. Thank them for the specific mention and ask if they'd add a link to [URL]. Under 90 words, no flattery, one clear ask.

45 Offer yourself as a local expert to reporters



1 HOUR

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Local news sites are sources AI tools and Google trust. One quote in a local story can do more for you than a dozen directory listings.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Find 3 local reporters or editors who cover business, home or your industry.
2. Email each with a short pitch: a seasonal tip, a local trend or a small data point from your own work.
3. Offer yourself as a source for future stories and keep it under 100 words.
4. Follow up once, 2 weeks later.

AI PROMPT

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] in [CITY]. Suggest 5 timely story angles a local reporter might want this [MONTH or SEASON], based on my experience: [DETAILS]. Then write a pitch email under 100 words for the best angle, offering myself as a source.

46 Complete your LinkedIn company page



1 HOUR

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Microsoft's Copilot draws on LinkedIn as well as Bing, and every AI tool uses LinkedIn to check who runs a business. An empty or outdated company page is a missed chance to be described correctly.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Fill in the About section with the same description you use everywhere else.
2. Add your website, industry, size, location and specialties.
3. Connect your team members to the page.
4. Post at least monthly so it looks active.

AI PROMPT

Here's how my business is described on my website: [PASTE]. Write a LinkedIn company About section under 2,000 characters that matches it, then suggest 10 specialties and 4 post ideas for this month. Keep the facts identical to my website.

Advanced wins

Bigger levers for when the first three parts are done. They take more thought, and most of your competitors will never get to them.

47 Use the same brand description everywhere ☐

2 HOURS

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

AI tools build a picture of your business from every place it appears. When your name, description and founder details match everywhere, they repeat them with confidence. When they conflict, the tools hedge or get it wrong.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Write one standard 2-sentence description of the business and a short founder bio.
2. Use them on your site, LinkedIn, Google Business Profile, Crunchbase and industry profiles, and spell your brand name the same way everywhere.
3. List all those profiles in your Organization schema's sameAs field.
4. Consider a Wikidata entry once independent articles have written about you. Leave Wikipedia alone unless you've had real press coverage.

AI PROMPT

Here's how my business is currently described on my website, LinkedIn, Google Business Profile and [OTHER]: [PASTE]. Write one standard 2-sentence description and a 3-sentence founder bio I can use everywhere, keeping facts consistent. Then list the differences you found between the current versions.

48 Target the searches that show AI Overviews



HALF DAY

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Google shows an AI Overview above many searches, especially long questions. In a 2025 study of 57,000 search results by Botify and DemandSphere, 75% of the links cited in AI Overviews came from pages already ranking in Google's top 12. Pages ranking 13 to 35 are the closest to getting cited.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Export your queries from Search Console and filter for ones where you rank between 5 and 35.
2. Search the longer, question-style ones and note which show an AI Overview and which sites it cites.
3. Compare your page with the cited ones and add what's missing: a direct answer, clearer headings, specifics.
4. Recheck monthly.

AI PROMPT

Here is the AI Overview text Google shows for [QUERY], the pages it cites, and my page's content: [PASTE]. What does the AI Overview say that my page doesn't say clearly? Suggest specific additions or rewrites, in order, that would make my page a better source to cite. No keyword stuffing.

49 Make your pages readable without JavaScript



1 HOUR TO CHECK

YOU + WEB DEV

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Most AI crawlers can't run JavaScript. If your content only appears after scripts load, a page can look empty to ChatGPT and Perplexity even though it looks fine to you.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Turn off JavaScript in your browser settings and reload your main pages. Whatever disappears is invisible to many AI crawlers.
2. Check your robots.txt allows the AI search crawlers: OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User, Claude-SearchBot, PerplexityBot.
3. Decide separately whether to allow the training crawlers (GPTBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended). Blocking them doesn't affect Google Search.
4. If important content depends on JavaScript, ask your developer about server-side rendering.

AI PROMPT

Here is my robots.txt file: [PASTE]. List every AI-related crawler it allows or blocks, explain whether each one is used for training or for search answers, and suggest changes if my goal is to appear in AI search results. My preference on AI training is: [ALLOW or BLOCK].

50 Answer questions on Reddit and Quora under your own name



30 MINUTES A WEEK

YOU

NEW FOR 2026

WHY IT MATTERS

Forums are one of the biggest sources AI tools cite. In Otterly's 2025 study of 10,000 prompts, about 40% of cited links were forum or community content. A helpful answer from a real expert gets seen by searchers and by the tools summarizing the thread.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Search Google for site:reddit.com plus your topic to find active threads on questions your customers ask.
2. Answer as yourself, with specifics from your experience.
3. Mention your business only when it's relevant and the community allows it.
4. Skip fake accounts and planted comments. They break the rules and can damage your name.

AI PROMPT

Here is a Reddit question and the top replies: [PASTE]. I'm a [ROLE] with [YEARS] years of experience in [FIELD]. Help me draft a reply that adds something the other replies missed, using this experience: [DETAILS]. Conversational, under 200 words, and don't mention my business.

51 Upgrade your author bios



1 HOUR YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Readers and Google both want evidence that someone qualified wrote the advice. Replace "Admin" bylines with a named author, a photo and specific experience.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Give every post a real author with a name and photo.
2. Write a bio listing specific experience: years, industries, certifications, notable projects.
3. Link to the author's LinkedIn and an author page listing all their posts.
4. Show a short version at the end of every post.

AI PROMPT

Here's my LinkedIn About section and experience: [PASTE]. Write a 50-word author bio for the end of blog posts and a 150-word version for my author page. Lead with experience relevant to [TOPIC], use numbers where I've given them, and write in third person without superlatives.

52 Publish an editorial policy



1 HOUR YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

Google's quality guidelines ask who wrote a page and why they should be trusted. A short editorial policy answers that for readers and search engines, including how you use AI.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Write a short page: who writes your content, how facts are checked, how you use AI, and how often pages are reviewed.
2. Add a byline to every post that links to the author's bio.
3. Show published and updated dates.
4. Link the policy from your footer.

AI PROMPT

Write a short editorial policy page for [BUSINESS], a [TYPE] with [N] people writing content. Cover who writes our content and their qualifications [DETAILS], how we check facts, how we use AI tools in drafting [YOUR PRACTICE], and how often we review pages. Plain language, under 300 words.

53 Build a "People also ask" question cluster



HALF DAY

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

The "People also ask" box shows the follow-up questions searchers have. Longer questions are also where AI Overviews show up most: Botify found searches of 5 or more words triggered them 73.6% of the time.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Search your main topic and expand the "People also ask" box to collect 10 or more questions, or use AlsoAsked.
2. Group related questions and order them the way a reader would ask them.
3. Answer each in 2 to 3 sentences, direct answer first, under a question heading.
4. Link each answer to the deeper page on your site where one exists.

AI PROMPT

Here are 12 "People also ask" questions for [TOPIC]: [PASTE]. Group them into 3 or 4 sections, order them the way a reader would ask them, and draft a 2 to 3 sentence answer for each, direct answer first. Mark any answer that needs my own numbers or experience with [ADD].

54 Cover the related topics your page is missing



2 HOURS

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

AI tools break one question into many smaller searches behind the scenes. Pages that cover the related angles, terms and follow-up questions get pulled in for more of them.

HOW TO DO IT

1. List the subtopics and terms the top 3 ranking pages mention that yours doesn't.
2. Check the topic's Wikipedia page and AlsoAsked for related ideas.
3. Add the 5 most useful ones, each with a sentence or more of real explanation.
4. Leave out anything a reader wouldn't miss.

AI PROMPT

Here is my page [PASTE] and the text of the top 3 ranking pages for [QUERY] [PASTE]. List the concepts and subtopics the top pages cover that mine doesn't, ranked by how useful they'd be to a reader. For the top 5, suggest where on my page each would fit.

55 Redirect 404 pages that still have links



1 HOUR

YOU + WEB DEV

WHY IT MATTERS

Old addresses that now show a 404 error can still have links pointing at them from other sites. Redirecting them sends those visitors, and the value of those links, to a live page.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In Search Console, open Pages and export "Not found (404)".
2. Check which have links from other sites or past traffic.
3. Add a 301 redirect from each to the most relevant live page.
4. Don't send everything to the homepage. Google treats that like a 404 anyway.

AI PROMPT

Here is a list of 404 URLs from Google Search Console: [PASTE]. Here are my live URLs with titles: [PASTE]. Match each 404 to the most relevant live page for a 301 redirect, based on the words in the URL. If nothing is a good match, say leave as 404.

56 Fix pages competing for the same search



2 HOURS

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

When 2 of your pages target the same search, Google flips between them and often ranks neither well. Merging or separating them gives one page a clear shot.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In Search Console Performance, filter by a main query, then open the Pages tab to see if more than one page gets impressions.
2. Decide whether the pages serve the same need.
3. If they do, merge the best content into one page and 301 redirect the other.
4. If they don't, point one page at a different search and update its title and headings.

AI PROMPT

These 2 pages on my site both get impressions for [QUERY]: Page A [PASTE] and Page B [PASTE]. Tell me whether they serve the same search intent. If yes, recommend which to keep and what to move into it. If no, suggest a distinct target query and new title for the weaker page.

57 Clean up tracking and filter URLs



1 HOUR

YOU + WEB DEV

WHY IT MATTERS

Tracking tags, filters and session IDs create endless copies of the same page. Crawlers waste time on them and ranking signals get split between copies.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In Search Console, look under Pages for addresses with a "?" that are indexed or flagged as duplicates.
2. Check each page's canonical tag points to the clean address.
3. Stop using UTM-tagged links inside your own site. They're for outside campaigns.
4. Make sure your sitemap lists only clean addresses.

AI PROMPT

Here is a list of URLs with parameters that Google has crawled on my site: [PASTE]. Group them by parameter, explain what each parameter probably does, and tell me which need a canonical tag, which should be removed from internal links, and which are fine.

58 Test new meta descriptions on your money pages



30 MINUTES, THEN 4 WEEKS

YOU

WHY IT MATTERS

If a page ranks well but gets few clicks, the snippet is usually the problem. Small wording changes can lift clicks with no change in ranking.

HOW TO DO IT

1. In Search Console, find pages with plenty of impressions and a click-through rate below your site average.
2. Rewrite the title or description on 5 of them, changing one thing each.
3. Note the date, wait 4 weeks, then compare click-through rate for the same length of time before and after.
4. Keep what worked. One test worth trying: delete an overlong description and let Google write the snippet.

AI PROMPT

Here are 5 pages with their title, meta description, average position and click-through rate from Google Search Console: [PASTE]. For each, write 2 alternative meta descriptions under 155 characters that give a specific reason to click, and explain the one thing each version changes so I can test it.

TRACKER

Your 58-win checklist

Tick each win as you ship it. Start with Part 1 and work down.

FOUNDATIONS

- ☐ **01** Set up Google Analytics 4 and Search Console properly
- ☐ **02** Rewrite titles and meta descriptions on your top 10 pages
- ☐ **03** Fix your heading structure
- ☐ **04** Link from your strongest pages to your weakest
- ☐ **05** Compress and resize your images
- ☐ **06** Write alt text that describes the image
- ☐ **07** Make every page load over HTTPS
- ☐ **08** Fix broken internal links
- ☐ **09** Submit a clean XML sitemap
- ☐ **10** Add canonical tags to stop duplicate pages competing
- ☐ **11** Add business schema to your homepage
- ☐ **12** Answer real customer questions on your service pages
- ☐ **13** Delay scripts that slow your pages down
- ☐ **14** Shorten messy URLs
- ☐ **15** Show a "last updated" date
- ☐ **16** Refresh one post that's losing traffic
- ☐ **17** Fix your favicon
- ☐ **18** Add a call to action to your top blog posts
- ☐ **19** Add a sticky call or book button on mobile
- ☐ **20** Offer a free resource on your top information post
- ☐ **30** Add a table of contents with jump links
- ☐ **31** Add chapters and captions to your videos
- ☐ **32** Track visits from AI assistants in GA4
- ☐ **33** Add "AI assistant" to your "How did you hear about us?" field
- ☐ **34** Ask AI tools who they recommend, every month
- ☐ **35** Make sure AI crawlers aren't blocked by your firewall
- ☐ **36** Get important facts out of images and PDFs

LOCAL AND REPUTATION

- ☐ **37** Refresh your Google Business Profile
- ☐ **38** Clean up your business listings across the web
- ☐ **39** Ask for reviews the right way
- ☐ **40** Reply to every review within 48 hours
- ☐ **41** Put named testimonials on your service pages
- ☐ **42** Show up on your industry's trusted review site
- ☐ **43** Build one page per core city you serve
- ☐ **44** Turn unlinked mentions into links
- ☐ **45** Offer yourself as a local expert to reporters
- ☐ **46** Complete your LinkedIn company page

ADVANCED

- ☐ **47** Use the same brand description everywhere
- ☐ **48** Target the searches that show AI Overviews
- ☐ **49** Make your pages readable without JavaScript
- ☐ **50** Answer questions on Reddit and Quora under your own name
- ☐ **51** Upgrade your author bios
- ☐ **52** Publish an editorial policy
- ☐ **53** Build a "People also ask" question cluster
- ☐ **54** Cover the related topics your page is missing
- ☐ **55** Redirect 404 pages that still have links
- ☐ **56** Fix pages competing for the same search
- ☐ **57** Clean up tracking and filter URLs
- ☐ **58** Test new meta descriptions on your money pages

AI SEARCH

- ☐ **21** Publish a brand facts page
- ☐ **22** Connect your people and brand with schema
- ☐ **23** Set up Bing Webmaster Tools and IndexNow
- ☐ **24** Put the answer first in every section
- ☐ **25** Build a glossary of your industry's terms
- ☐ **26** Publish a page of sourced statistics
- ☐ **27** Add comparison tables
- ☐ **28** Publish one "best for" or "alternatives" page
- ☐ **29** Add breadcrumbs

Sources behind the 2026 updates: Anderson, How to Get AI to Recommend Your Local Business (2026). Carter, The New Rules of AI Search (2026). Gotch, AI SEO For Dummies (2026). Stockebrand, Answer Engine Optimization (2026). Botify and DemandSphere, AI Overviews Report (2025). Otterly, Generative Engine Optimization Guide (2025). Penn, Generative AI for SEO and PPC Marketers (2026).

WHAT NEXT

SEO is one workflow. Your business runs on dozens.

If this playbook helped, the same approach works across the rest of your operations: find the repeatable work, document it, then decide where AI saves real hours.

That's what a Foresight AI Readiness Audit does for founder-led teams of 5 to 20 people. You get a map of your workflows, a ranked list of where AI pays off first, and a plan your team can follow.

Book an AI Readiness Audit at davidjforer.com



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